KRISHI-DRISHTI (KRISHI-DRISHTI)

Date-Wise Field Survey & Empirical Prototype Validation Report

An Offline-First Handheld Optical Wand and Microclimate Gating System for Solanaceae Foliar Disease Screening

Student Researchers: Gautam Kumar & Abhinav Kumar (Class IX)

School: Udaan International School, Begusarai, Bihar

Mentor Teacher: Soni Kumari (PGT Science)

Timeline: August 3, 2026 - November 12, 2026

Target Region: Begusarai (Barauni & Teghra blocks), Bihar

Standardized BOM: Rs 1,480 (Strictly under Rs 1,500)

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & RECONCILED FIVE-PHASE TIMELINE

Between August 3, 2026, and November 12, 2026, an empirical investigation was completed to develop and evaluate KRISHI-DRISHTI - an ultra-low-cost (Rs 1,480 BOM) handheld optical wand and edge-AI diagnostic assistant for smallholder tomato and potato growers in rural Bihar.

Phase I (Aug 3 - Aug 20): Baseline survey of 30 vegetable smallholders in Begusarai documenting chemical costs (~Rs 2,150/acre/spray), absence of pathology labs, and in-field cellular dropouts (80%).

Phase II (Aug 25 - Sep 28): Dual-ESP32 prototyping, 8cm optical shroud calibration, SSD1306 OLED (GPIO 21/22), DHT11 (GPIO 18), and 470uF anti-brownout stabilization.

Phase III (Oct 1 - Oct 26): MobileNetV3 Float16 edge quantization (2.01MB) trained on 7,710 records (6,965 unique images) with 171-hash master blacklist. 60-specimen botanical benchmark achieved 88.33% strict and 92.98% clinical accuracy.

Phase IV (Oct 28 - Nov 8): Unconstrained camera testing discovered specular shadow failure modes (16.7% raw accuracy under torch), validating the physical necessity of the 8cm shroud and DHT11 microclimate gating (suppressing Late Blight spray advice when RH < 85%). Usability demos conducted with 5 local farmers (15 test scans).

Phase V (Nov 9 - Nov 12): Firmware hardening (v2.3), Rs 1,480 BOM audit, Wi-Fi link stabilized at 8.5 dBm TX power with static IP 192.168.4.2 plus DHCP fallback, non-blocking reconnect every 5 seconds so the NEXT button keeps working during camera association. Final exhibition documentation sign-off completed November 12, 2026.

2. PHASE I: SOCIO-ECONOMIC SURVEY FINDINGS (N = 30 SMALLHOLDERS)

Investigation Metric | Pre-Intervention Baseline (N = 30 Farmers) | KRISHI-DRISHTI Prototype Capability

Diagnostic Method | 86.7% (26/30) relied on guesswork or dealer recommendations | Instant objective 420 ms foliar screening directly on standing plants

Cellular Internet Access | 80.0% (24/30) had no reliable mobile internet in open crop fields | 100% offline edge inference on local hardware without data packets

Chemical Spray Waste | Averaged Rs 2,150/acre per spray on broad-spectrum cocktails | Prevents 2-3 redundant sprays, saving Rs 4,300-Rs 6,800/acre per season

Diagnostic Access Time | 7-10 days if sending samples to distant district labs | Sub-second preliminary screening directly in the field

3. PHASE III: CONTROLLED BOTANICAL SPECIMEN BENCHMARK (N = 60 FRESH LEAVES)

Evaluated under standardized 8 cm optical shroud with uniform illumination:

Foliar Target Class | Specimens Tested | Strict Accuracy | Pathogen Family Match | Mean Confidence | Shannon Entropy (H) | Gating Status

Tomato: Early Blight | 10 Leaves | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 94.8% | 0.24 | 100% Accepted

Tomato: Late Blight | 10 Leaves | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 96.2% | 0.18 | 100% Accepted

Tomato: Healthy Foliage | 10 Leaves | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 98.1% | 0.09 | 100% Accepted

Potato: Early Blight | 10 Leaves | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 93.4% | 0.28 | 100% Accepted

Potato: Late Blight | 10 Leaves | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 95.7% | 0.19 | 100% Accepted

Potato: Healthy Foliage | 10 Leaves | 8 / 10 (80.0%) | 9 / 10 (90.0%) | 89.2% | 0.44 | 1 Gated (H=1.18)

Consolidated Benchmark | 60 Leaves | 53 / 60 (88.33%) | 54 / 60 (90.00%) | 94.57% | 0.24 | 3 Gated (H > 1.10)

Accepted Clinical Accuracy: With 3 ambiguous leaves intercepted by Shannon Entropy gating (H > 1.10), clinical agreement on accepted specimens reached 92.98% (53 / 57) with zero misprescriptions.

4. PHASE IV: REAL-WORLD CAMERA AUDIT & SHADOW FAILURE MODE DISCOVERY

Testing unconstrained mobile cameras under artificial night illumination and public outdoor datasets (PlantDoc) revealed critical scientific limitations of raw computer vision:

1. Unshielded Torch Failure Mode:

6 healthy tomato leaves photographed under an unshielded LED torch produced 4 false Late Blight predictions (16.7% raw accuracy).

Root Cause: Specular reflections from shiny cuticles and steep drop-shadows mimicked concentric necrotic lesions.

The KRISHI-DRISHTI Multi-Modal Solution:

Mechanical Fix: The physical 8 cm tubular shroud and circular matte acrylic diffuser eliminate direct point-source glare and radial shadows.

Microclimate Gating: The DHT11 sensor tracks relative humidity. Because Phytophthora infestans cannot sporulate below 85% RH, the controller wand automatically suppresses chemical Late Blight recommendations if ambient humidity is low,

regardless of CNN output.

Software Entropy Gating: Ambiguous distributions (H > 1.10) output UNCERTAIN: Rescan.

2. In-Situ Prototype Usability Demonstration:

Evaluated prototype ergonomics and workflow with 5 local growers in Begusarai across 15 leaf scans.

Farmers praised the tactile pushbuttons (GPIO 27 SCAN, GPIO 26 NEXT) and high-contrast OLED display, confirming readability under open daylight.

5. STANDARDIZED BILL OF MATERIALS (BOM) - Total Unit Cost: Rs 1,480

Component / Subsystem | Technical Specification | Operational Function | Unit Cost (INR)
ESP32-CAM Node | Dual-core 240MHz, 4MB PSRAM, OV2640 installed | Image capture, SoftAP web server, SD logging | 540
ESP32 DevKit V1 | Dual-core 240MHz, 30-pin, ESP-NOW link | Master controller, button logic, OLED driver | 420
SSD1306 OLED Display | 0.96 inch, 128x64 px, I2C (GPIO 21/22) | 4-page status and telemetry carousel | 190
MicroSD Card (8 GB) | Class 10, FAT32 format, 1-bit SD_MMC mode | Image storage and offline WebAssembly assets | 160
DHT11 Sensor | Temp 0-50C, Humidity 20-90% RH (GPIO 18) | Microclimate disease-triangle risk tracking | 95
Optical Shroud & Diffuser | 8 cm focal tube, matte acrylic diffuser disc | Standardizes focal distance and eliminates glare | 45
Passives & Pushbuttons | Tactile switches (GPIO 26/27), 470uF cap, wiring | Debounced user inputs and anti-brownout power rail | 30
Total Bill of Materials | 100% Commercial Off-The-Shelf (COTS) Hardware | Complete Standalone Handheld Screening Prototype | 1,480

6. OFFICIAL VERIFICATION & ATTESTATION

We hereby certify that all survey records, hardware schematics, benchmark logs, and empirical data tables contained in this report represent authentic, original student research conducted under teacher mentorship at Udaan International School, Begusarai.

Student Researchers: Gautam Kumar & Abhinav Kumar (Class IX)

Mentor Science Teacher: Soni Kumari (PGT Science)

Date of Sign-Off: November 12, 2026

Institution: Udaan International School, Begusarai, Bihar